

CentCompras — User Manual

The Item Console · Version 1.0 · For warehouse staff (admin / manager / operator)

Also available: [Purchase orders](#) at `/manage/purchase-orders/` · [Goods receipt & stock](#) at `/manage/goods-receipts/` · [Manager catalog](#) at `/manage/catalog/` · [Branches & Requisição interna](#) at `/branch/...` · [Edge cases & limits](#) · [Admin & Superuser Reference](#).

Where do I go?

Open your browser and go to:

`https://<your-domain>/`

(During development on your own machine, use: `http://127.0.0.1:8015/`)

You'll be taken to the **login page**. After signing in you land on the dashboard (`/`). That page lists every warehouse console (items, catalog, purchase orders, **approval limits**, goods receipts, **internal requests**, **branch approval limits**) plus branch pages (`/branch/select/`, catalog, requisição, receipts) and the JSON APIs.

Signed in as **warehouse.admin@centcompras.dev**

Groups: warehouse_admins

[Sign out](#)

CentCompras

Your Django permissions

These come from your group (plus every permission if you are a superuser).

- `inventory.add_goodsreceipt`
- `inventory.can_adjust_stock`
- `inventory.can_issue_goods`
- `inventory.change_goodsreceipt`
- `inventory.view_goodsreceipt`
- `inventory.view_goodsreceiptline`
- `inventory.view_stockmovement`
- `orders.view_internalrequest`
- `orders.view_internalrequestline`
- `procurement.add_purchaseorder`
- `procurement.can_approve`
- `procurement.change_purchaseorder`
- `procurement.delete_purchaseorder`
- `procurement.view_purchaseorder`
- `procurement.view_purchaseorderchangelog`
- `products.add_familyproduct`
- `products.add_item`

The main catalogue working screen is the **Item console** at:

`https://<your-domain>/manage/items/`

Bookmark the console URL — it's where the day-to-day catalogue work happens.

1. Getting started

1.1 Signing in

1. Enter your **email** in the Email field.
2. Enter your **password** (the one your administrator gave you).
3. Click **Sign in**.

If you mistype, you'll see "Invalid email or password."

Login

Email

Password

1.2 Signing out

Open the **Settings** gear (top-right of the console). **Sign out** is a small link on the same line as the **Settings** title (far right). **Help** sits beside the Settings gear as a blue **?** icon (outside the popover).

1.3 Language

The whole console works in two languages. Set **Language** on the staff dashboard (/) — the control sits in the top-right bar, next to theme:

- **English**
- **Português**

The choice is remembered in this browser and applies to every warehouse console, Company Voice, and request threads. Branch staff set the same control on the branch catalog (/branch/catalog/). The **Settings** gear shows signed-in email, a small **Sign out** link, and **Sign out other devices**. **Help** is the blue **?** icon next to the gear.

1.4 Light / dark theme

Use the **theme** button on the staff dashboard (/) — next to **Language** — to switch between **Light theme** and **Dark theme**. Also remembered in this browser. Branch staff use the same control on the branch catalog (/branch/catalog/).

2. Your role — what you can do

There are three warehouse roles. The buttons you see depend on your role — a feature that's missing from your screen is simply **not part of your role**, not a bug.

Role	See items	Add / edit	Deactivate / reactivate	Delete
Admin (warehouse_admins)	[OK]	[OK]	[OK]	[OK]
Manager (warehouse_managers)	[OK]	[OK]	[OK]	[NO]
Operator (warehouse_data_operators)	[OK] (read-only)	[NO]	[NO]	[NO]

- **Operator** sees the same list but with **View** instead of **Edit**, no checkboxes, and no save buttons.
- The Django `/admin/` screen is for the **site superuser only** — it is not part of this manual.

3. The console at a glance

The console is one screen, split into three areas.

CENTCOMPRAS
Item console

Search code or description All families All sub-families All statuses All units Bulk action Apply

Families Sub-families Suppliers **New item**

Showing 61 of 61 items

☐	Code	Description	Family	Sub-family	Unit	Reorder	VAT	Status	Actions
☐	CEM-50	Cement 50kg	Cement	—	Kilogram	20.000	16%	Active	Edit Deacti
☐	CEM-25	Cement 25kg	Cement	—	Kilogram	15.000	16%	Active	Edit Deacti
☐	CEM-40	Cement 40kg rapid	Cement	—	Kilogram	25.000	16%	Active	Edit Deacti
☐	CEM-WHITE	White cement 25kg	Cement	—	Kilogram	10.000	16%	Active	Edit Deacti
☐	CEM-OLD	Cement discontinued bag	Cement	—	Kilogram	0.000	16%	Inactive	Edit Reacti
☐	SAND-1KG	Sand 1kg	Aggregates	—	Kilogram	50.000	16%	Active	Edit Deacti

A. Top bar - App name (**CentCompras**) and title (**Item console** / Gestão de artigos) - **Families**, **Sub-families**, and **Suppliers** — open the master-data drawers. On a narrow window they collapse under **Master data** (Dados mestres). - **Settings** gear (top-right) — opens a panel with "Signed in as you@company", a small **Sign out** link on the Settings title row, and **Sign out other devices**. **Help** is the blue **?** icon next to the gear (placeholder). Language and theme live on the [staff dashboard](#) (/).

CENTCOMPRAS

Item console

Search code or description

All families

All sub-families

All statuses

All units

Families

Sub-families

Suppliers

New item

Showing 61 of 61 items

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Settings

Signed in as warehouse.admin@centcompras.dev

Language English

Dark theme

Sign out

B. Toolbar (filters & actions)

Control	What it does
Search box	Find by code or description
Family dropdown	Filter by family
Sub-family dropdown	Filter by sub-family (scoped to the selected family when one is set)
Status dropdown	All / Active / Inactive
Unit dropdown	Filter by unit of measure
Bulk action + Apply	Deactivate/reactivate several items at once
New item	Create a new item

C. Items table - One row per item, with columns: **Code**, **Description**, **Family**, **Sub-family**, **Unit**, **Reorder**, **VAT**, **Status**, **Actions** - **Actions** is **Edit** (or **View** if you cannot change items). Deactivate / Reactivate is not on the row — open the item drawer, or use **Bulk action** for several items. - A checkbox column (if your role can edit) for bulk actions - Click any row to open it

Close a panel: press **Escape** to dismiss the front-most overlay — the **Master data** menu, the Settings gear, a dialog (**Cancel**), or a drawer (**Close**). If a dialog is open on top of a drawer, the first Escape closes the dialog; a second Escape closes the drawer.

4. Browsing and filtering items

4.1 Search

Type in the **Search** box to filter by **internal code** or **description**. It filters as you type.

4.2 Filter by family

Choose a family from the **Family** dropdown (Todas as famílias = all families). Only items in that family are shown.

4.3 Filter by sub-family

Choose a sub-family from the **Sub-family** dropdown (Todas as sub-famílias = all sub-families). If a family is already selected, only sub-families under that family appear. Leave empty to show all sub-families (or all in the chosen family).

4.4 Filter by status

- **All statuses** — every item
- **Active** (Ativo) — items currently available
- **Inactive** (Inativo) — items removed from the catalogue

4.5 Filter by unit

Choose a unit (piece, kg, g, m, m², m³, l) to see only items measured that way.

4.6 Sorting

Click any column header to sort by it — click again to reverse. Sortable columns: **Code, Description, Family, Sub-family, Unit, Reorder, VAT, Status**.

4.7 Result count

Above the table you'll see "**Showing X of Y items**" (A mostrar X de Y artigos) so you always know how many match.

5. Working with items

5.1 Creating a new item

1. Click **New item** (Novo artigo).
2. Fill the form (fields below). **Internal code** and **retail price greater than zero** are required before Genesis.
3. Click **Save** (Guardar).
4. Confirm **Genesis** in the dialog — the item is created and activated in one step.

Important: you cannot skip Genesis. If you cancel the dialog, nothing is saved. There is no inactive orphan row.

[SCREENSHOT] [SCREENSHOT — "Confirm Genesis" dialog (before save)]

The item form fields:

Field	Required	Notes
Internal code	Yes (new items)	Your own reference, e.g. CEM-50 or CABLE-2.5 . Must be unique (case-insensitive). Only letters, digits, dots (.), hyphens (-), and underscores (_) — no spaces or other symbols. Max 64 characters. Saved as uppercase (cem-50 becomes CEM-50). Cannot be changed after the first save (legacy items with an empty code may set it once).

Field	Required	Notes
Description	Yes	What the item is.
Family	Yes	The group it belongs to (see §7).
Sub-family	No	Optional finer grouping under the family (see §7). Leave empty for none.
Unit	Yes	piece / kg / g / m / m ² / m ³ / l
VAT rate	Yes	1%, 3%, 7%, 16%, Exempt
Reorder level	Yes	The level that later triggers reordering.
On hand / Available	(read-only, edit only)	Physical warehouse stock and what is still free to promise after reservations. Not editable here.
Retail price	Yes (> 0)	Selling price for Genesis (see §6). Must be greater than zero on create.
Wholesale price	No	Selling price (see §6).
Special price	No	Selling price (see §6).
Reason	No	A note explaining why you're changing this (stored in history).

5.2 Editing an item

Click the item's row (or its **Edit** button), change any field except **internal code** (read-only after save), and **Save**. The reason field is optional but recommended.

5.3 Deactivating an item

Deactivation **removes the item from the active catalogue** (it isn't deleted — its history is kept).

- Open the item (click the row or **Edit**).
- In the drawer, click **Deactivate** (Desativar).
- Choose a reason:
 - **Temporarily unavailable** (Indisponível temporariamente)
 - **No longer commercialized** (Deixou de ser comercializado)
 - **Other** (Outro) — describe it
- Confirm.

Several items at once: use **Bulk action** → **Deactivate** in the toolbar (see §5.5).

5.4 Reactivating an item

Open the inactive item and click **Reactivate** (Reativar) in the drawer. Give a reason. It returns to the catalogue. Several items: **Bulk action** → **Reactivate**.

5.5 Bulk actions

1. Tick the checkboxes of several items.
2. Choose **Deactivate** or **Reactivate** in the **Bulk action** dropdown.
3. Click **Apply**.
4. Give a reason when asked.

6. Selling prices vs buying price

Two different kinds of price — easy to confuse.

	Selling prices	Buying / cost price
What	What we sell the item for	What we pay the supplier for it
How many	3 (retail, wholesale, special)	1 per supplier
Who sets it	A senior person, manually	Pulled automatically from the supplier's price list
Where	On the item form	In the supplier prices (see §9)

- **Retail / Wholesale / Special** are three price levels you type on the item itself. They do not change on their own.
- The **cost (buying) price** is the opposite: it's dynamic. It comes from the **supplier price list** (§9), so when a supplier's price changes there, the cost follows automatically.

7. Families

A **family** groups related items (e.g. Cement, Pipes, Electrical). Every item must belong to a family.

1. Click **Families** (Famílias) in the top bar. On a narrow window, open **Master data** (Dados mestres) first.
2. Click **New family** (Nova família), type the name, confirm.
3. Family names are unique (case-insensitive) — you can't create two families with the same name.

Deactivate a family: open it and choose to deactivate. Existing items keep the family; you just can't add new items to it.

View history: use the **History** action on a family row to see who created or changed it.

7.1 Sub-families

A **sub-family** is an optional second level under a family (e.g. Cement → Bags, Pipes → PVC). Items do **not** require a sub-family — family alone is enough for Genesis and activation.

1. Click **Sub-families** (Sub-famílias) in the top bar. On a narrow window, open **Master data** first.
2. Click **New sub-family** (Nova sub-família), choose the **parent family**, type the name, confirm.
3. Sub-family names are unique **within each family** (case-insensitive) — the same name under two different families is allowed.
4. On the item form, pick a sub-family only after choosing the family; changing the family clears incompatible sub-family choices.

Deactivate a sub-family: open the drawer and deactivate the row. Existing items keep the sub-family; you cannot assign **new** items to an inactive sub-family or to a sub-family whose parent family is inactive.

View history: use **History** on a sub-family row (same pattern as families).

8. Suppliers

A **supplier** is a company we buy from — master data that will be used for purchasing.

1. Click **Suppliers** (Fornecedores) in the top bar. On a narrow window, open **Master data** first.
2. Click **New supplier** (Novo fornecedor), fill the form: - **Name** (required, unique) - **Contact name, Email, Phone, Notes** (optional)
3. Save.

Deactivate a supplier to stop ordering from it (kept in history, not deleted).

9. Supplier prices (cost prices)

Each supplier × item pair can have a **cost price** — how much that supplier charges for that item.

9.1 Adding a cost price

1. Open **Suppliers**.
2. On the supplier's row, click **Supplier prices**.
3. Click **Add price** (Adicionar preço).
4. Pick the **Item**, enter the **Cost price**, and optionally tick **Primary**.
5. Save.

9.2 The "Primary" flag — what it means

Primary marks this supplier as the **preferred supplier for that item**.

- Only **one** supplier can be primary per item. If you tick a second supplier as primary, the first is automatically un-ticked.
- The item's **buying price** is taken from the **primary** supplier (if none is primary, the cheapest supplier is used).
- In the future, when we place purchase orders, the **primary** supplier will be **suggested automatically** — and you'll still be able to override it.

Tip: Example: if **AquaFlow** is primary for **VALVE-15** and you later add a second supplier for VALVE-15, AquaFlow stays the default choice (and its price is the item's buying price) unless you mark the other one primary.

9.3 Editing a cost price

Open the supplier's prices, change the cost or toggle **Primary**, and save.

9.4 Seeing an item's suppliers

Open any item — its drawer shows a **Supplier prices** section listing every supplier and cost for that item (read-only). This is where you check "who supplies this, and at what cost."

10. Audit history

Every change is recorded — **who** did it, **what** changed, and **when** (with an optional reason).

- **Item history:** open an item → the **History** section at the bottom of its drawer.
- **Family / supplier history:** open the drawer → **History** action on the row.

This is your safety net: nothing is ever silently overwritten.

11. Dates, timezone, language & theme

- **Dates** are shown as **DD/MM/YYYY** (day, month, year), with a 24-hour time — e.g. `20/08/2026 10:30`.
 - **Timezone:** times are shown in your local time, wherever you are. A colleague in Singapore sees the same event in Singapore time; you see it in Portugal time. (The system stores everything in UTC and converts automatically.) New users default to **Europe/Lisbon**.
 - **Language:** English / Português — set on the staff dashboard (/) or branch catalog (/ branch/catalog/); remembered in this browser.
 - **Theme:** light / dark — same bar as language; remembered.
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12. Related consoles

- [Purchase orders](#) — raise and approve supplier orders.
 - [Goods receipt & stock](#) — book in deliveries; stock is a ledger, never typed on the item.
 - [Manager catalog](#) — read-only stock + prices overview (/manage/catalog/).
 - [Branches & Requisição interna](#) — how satellite branches browse the catalogue, raise requests, and confirm arrivals.
 - [Edge cases, limits & troubleshooting](#) — the reference for error messages, numeric bounds, state-machine rules, and known gaps.
 - [Admin & Superuser Reference](#) — creating users, roles, permissions, branches, and branch memberships.
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13. FAQ

Q1. What does "Primary" mean on a supplier price? It marks the **preferred supplier** for that item. Only one per item; it's the source of the item's buying price, and (in future) the supplier suggested when purchasing. Always overridable.

Q2. What's the difference between selling price and buying price? Selling prices (retail / wholesale / special) are what we sell for — entered manually by a senior person. The buying/cost price is what we pay the supplier — taken automatically from the supplier price list.

Q3. Why are dates shown as DD/MM/YYYY? That's the European convention used across the app. `05/08/2026` means **5 August 2026**, not 8 May.

Q4. If someone in Singapore uses this, will times be wrong? No. Times adapt to each viewer's local timezone automatically. The system stores UTC and converts on display.

Q5. I created an item but it says "Inactive" — why? New items are created **active** when you confirm **Genesis** on save. If you cancel the Genesis dialog, nothing is saved. To add an inactive row for testing, use Django admin (superuser) or the `add_item` CLI without `--activate` (with `--activate`, pass `--retail-price` greater than 0).

Q6. I can't see the edit button / checkboxes — why? Your role is **operator** (read-only), or you don't have edit permission. Check §2. Ask your administrator if you think your role is wrong.

Q7. I forgot my password. There's no self-service reset yet. Ask your administrator, who can reset it for you.

Q8. What happens when I "deactivate" something? It's removed from the active list but **not deleted** — its history is preserved, and it can be reactivated later.

Q9. Can two items have the same internal code? No — internal codes are unique (case-insensitive). You'll get an error if you try to reuse one.

Q10. What characters can I use in an internal code? Letters (A–Z, a–z), digits (0–9), dots (.), hyphens (-), and underscores (_) only — for example CEM-50, CABLE-2.5, or TIMBER_2X4. Spaces and symbols such as @ or # are rejected. **The code is stored in uppercase** — typing `cem-50` saves as CEM-50. **Internal code is required on new items** and **cannot be changed after the first save** (legacy rows with an empty code may set it once).

Q11. Can I change an internal code later? No — after the item is saved, the code is locked. Plan the code before Genesis. Exception: an older item that still has an **empty** code may set it **once**.

Q12. On hand and Available differ — which one is the shelf? **On hand** is physical warehouse stock (the ledger). **Available** is what is still free to promise after approved requisições have held their share. You cannot type either number here — change stock with a [goods receipt](#) or (admin) Adjust stock. See [Branches & Requisição interna](#) §7.

14. Quick reference — unit & VAT

Units of measure: piece · kg (kilogram) · g (gram) · m (meter) · m² (square meter) · m³ (cubic meter) · l (liter)

VAT rates: 1% · 3% · 7% · 16% · Exempt